SAP INTEGRATION PROCESSES

Migrating from SAP PI/PO to Integration Suite

A customer-side view: why, how, and what we learned — a comprehensive roadmap

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What We'll Cover Today

1. **A Quick Look at PI/PO vs. Integration Suite**
   The key difference between the two platforms
2. **Why This Migration Is Different**
   What sets interface migration apart from other projects
3. **What Actually Has to Migrate**
   Artifacts, automation maturity, and an adapter cheat sheet
4. **Why Move Now**
   The support timeline, business risks, and who to involve
5. **The Migration Journey and Approaches**
   Phases, plus Big Bang vs. phased migration
6. **Managing the Cutover**
   Freeze, parallel run, go/no-go, rollback, and hypercare
7. **Risks and a Real Story from the Field**
   Mitigations, plus a customer experience
8. **Lessons, Success Factors, Roadmap and Wrap-Up**
   Practical recommendations and key takeaways

PI/PO VS. INTEGRATION SUITE

SAP PI/PO and Integration Suite, in Brief

SAP PI/PO

A long-standing, on-premise integration platform. It lets different systems — ERP, CRM, supplier systems, and more — exchange data with each other.

SAP Integration Suite

SAP's next-generation, cloud-based integration platform. It does the same job, but adds scalability, automation, and AI-assisted capabilities.

This migration is less about changing tools, and more about rethinking how your business processes actually run.

WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

Why This Migration Is Different

1

It's Logic, Not Just Data

Each interface encodes business rules, routing, and error handling that must be understood, not just copied

2

A Platform Paradigm Shift

Moving from a central on-premise broker to a distributed, cloud-native model; some patterns have no direct equivalent

3

Depth Beyond the Interface

Mappings, custom code, certificates, and modules all migrate differently — not just the channel itself

4

Live, Mission-Critical Traffic

Interfaces often run 24/7 for order flow and EDI — cutover has to be carefully choreographed

5

Dependencies You Don't Control

Trading partners, banks, and logistics providers sit outside your organization — and still need to test with you

Beyond Interfaces: What Actually Has to Migrate

Artifact	What Happens During Migration
Adapters (sender / receiver channels)	Re-mapped to Integration Suite adapters (see the cheat sheet)
Message mappings (graphical / XSLT)	Convert well in most cases
Java mappings & user-defined functions	Custom code doesn't auto-convert — needs manual review and rewrite
Value mappings & lookups	Migrate via configuration; some lookup sources (e.g. JDBC) need alternatives
ccBPM / integration processes	No direct equivalent — must be redesigned as Integration Flows
Certificates & keystores	Re-issued and re-imported; connectivity setup changes significantly
Custom modules (Java / EJB)	Typically rebuilt as script steps or API Management policies

The tool sitting on top of an interface is the easy part — what's inside it determines how hard the migration really is.

How Far Does Automation Go?

SAP keeps extending its migration tooling — from interface/channel-level conversion toward artifact and code-level conversion — aiming to get as close to 100% automated migration as possible. In practice, maturity still varies by artifact type:

Mostly Automated

- Standard adapters (HTTP, SOAP, SFTP, AS2)
- Graphical message mappings
- Simple value mappings

Partially Automated

- Mappings with complex conditions
- Some lookups and value mapping sources
- Adapter-specific fine-tuning

Manual Redesign Needed

- ccBPM / integration processes
- Java mappings & user-defined functions
- Custom modules

Practical implication: budget extra time for the last mile — legacy custom code and orchestration logic.

Adapter Migration Cheat Sheet: Effort by Adapter

PI/PO Adapter	Integration Suite Equivalent	Effort	Note
AS2	AS2 / AS4	Easy	—
HTTP_AAE	HTTP	Easy	—
SOAP	SOAP	Easy	—
SFTP	SFTP	Easy	—
OData	OData	Easy	—
RFC (Receiver)	RFC	Easy	Fully supported
IDoc_AAE	IDoc (HTTP-based)	Medium	Classic RFC-packed IDoc not supported
JDBC (Receiver)	JDBC	Medium	Limited database vendor support
JMS	AMQP / IBM MQ	Medium	Native JMS is internal-only in Integration Suite
File	FTP / SFTP	Medium	File Content Conversion replaced by CSV-to-XML / script steps
RFC (Sender)	RFC via Edge Integration Cell	Medium	Native adapter, but requires deploying the separate Edge Integration Cell runtime; SOAP + ABAP proxy is a lighter alternative
JDBC (Sender)	No native sender adapter	Medium	Common workaround: Timer + JDBC receiver polling; limited transaction handling

WHY NOW — 1/4

Why Now? The Clock Is Ticking

Dec 31, 2027

The date standard mainstream maintenance for SAP PI/PO ends

2030

The final date for the optional, extra-cost “extended maintenance” (limited scope)

- After 2027, patches and regulatory updates continue only under paid extended maintenance; after 2030, they stop entirely
- Running critical business processes on an unsupported system carries security and compliance risk
- Depending on company size, migration can take 12–24+ months — starting early is an advantage

Why Now? The Business-Side Risks

1. **Security Exposure**
   Without patches, cyber-security risk grows over time

2. **Compliance Risk**
   Once maintenance ends, new regulations (e.g. e-invoicing) won't be covered

3. **Knowledge Risk**
   The pool of people with PI/PO expertise keeps shrinking

4. **Competitive Disadvantage**
   A modern platform adapts faster to APIs and new business partnerships

5. **Cost Risk**
   Leaving it to the last minute forces rushed, expensive decisions

This Isn't Just an IT Project

At first glance...

A server swap, a new integration platform... it looks like a technical migration that stays in the background.

What it actually touches:

- Order and supply-chain processes (EDI)
- Invoicing
- Customer / supplier communication (B2B)
- Manufacturing and ERP integrations
- Reporting and compliance

Bringing business units in from day one cuts down on surprises later.

WHY NOW — 4/4

Who Needs a Seat at the Table?

1

IT / Integration Team

Runs the technical analysis, migration build, and testing

2

Process Owners

Define which processes are critical and their tolerance for downtime

3

B2B / Supplier Relations

Coordinates communication and testing with external partners

4

Security & Compliance

Confirms the new platform meets security and regulatory needs

5

Executive Sponsor

Provides budget, resources, and prioritization support

6

Migration Partner

Brings methodology, experience, and the right tooling

The Customer Journey: Migration Phases

1

Analysis & Inventory

Mapping existing interfaces and classifying complexity

2

Prioritization & Wave Planning

Which interface, which method, in what order

3

Pilot & First Wave

Validating on a small scale, and learning

4

Migration at Scale

Rolling out to production in waves

5

Stabilization & Monitoring

Hypercare and ongoing performance monitoring

MIGRATION JOURNEY — 2/2

Migration Approach: Big Bang or Phased?

Big Bang

Advantage: Completed quickly, a single cutover window

Disadvantage: High risk, little room for error, heavy testing load

Best suited for: Smaller environments with a limited number of simple interfaces

RECOMMENDED FOR MOST CUSTOMERS

Phased (Wave-Based)

Advantage: Risk is spread out, and lessons carry into the next wave

Disadvantage: Takes longer overall, both systems must run in parallel

Best suited for: Mid-to-large, complex integration landscapes (most customers)

CUTOVER

Cutover: The Make-or-Break Moment

1. **Freeze Changes Before Cutover**

   Lock down source-system changes ahead of the migration window

2. **Run in Parallel First**

   Dual-run old and new interfaces to validate before the final switch

3. **Loop In Trading Partners Early**

   EDI/B2B partners need advance notice and their own test windows

4. **Use a Clear Go/No-Go Checklist**

   Switch traffic — endpoints, routing — only once every checkpoint is green

5. **Keep a Rollback Plan Ready**

   Know exactly how, and how fast, you could revert if something breaks

6. **Run Hypercare Immediately After**

   Heightened monitoring and dedicated support right after go-live

Risks and How to Mitigate Them

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Downtime risk	Disrupts business continuity	Phased migration + parallel-run windows
Unclear scope	Timeline and cost overruns	Early, detailed inventory analysis
Loss of logic / knowledge	Faulty endpoints or process logic	Thorough documentation + an experienced partner
Insufficient testing	Issues surface only in production	Automated regression testing
Team capacity	Delays and pressure on the team	External partner support + clear role split

RISKS — 2/2

The Questions Customers Ask Most

Will we experience downtime?

A phased migration with parallel-run windows greatly reduces that risk.

What will it cost, and how long will it take?

Typically 12–24+ months, depending on size; a solid inventory analysis makes cost and timeline predictable.

Can our team handle the workload?

Working with an experienced partner complements your internal capacity.

Is there a data or integration risk?

Automated regression testing and monitoring provide assurance.

Do we have to change everything at once?

No; a phased plan is built based on priority and complexity.

What if new requirements come up?

A phased approach lets shifting priorities feed into later waves.

STORY FROM THE FIELD

Large-Scale Food Manufacturer

STARTING POINT

~2,000 interfaces, mostly SAP ECC/S4 to trading partners and internal systems — heavy on IDoc and proxy-based interfaces.

APPROACH

Migration-tool-assisted, wave-based rollout using the Pipeline Concept (generic inbound/outbound flows); an unusually large first wave moved 1,200 interfaces in 8 months. API Management was added to secure exposed endpoints.

CHALLENGE

Monitoring and logging needs weren't fully scoped up front; copying interfaces one-to-one through the pipeline model caused endpoint-logic mix-ups that were hard to debug.

LESSON LEARNED

The right tool saves serious time at scale — but monitoring needs must be clarified from the very start.

6 Key Lessons from the Migration Frontline

1

Early Assessment and Scoping

Don't move into design without understanding your current landscape. ***Lesson:*** *Time spent upfront saves weeks of rework.*

2

Unified Teams

Technical, functional, and business teams need to sync regularly. ***Lesson:*** *Speak the same language early.*

3

Connectivity & Security Take Longer

Certificates, VPNs, and firewalls require cross-team coordination. ***Lesson:*** *It's never "just a quick setup."*

4

Testing Is the Heart of the Project

Unit, integration, and end-to-end testing, with early business involvement. ***Lesson:*** *Testing isn't a phase — it's a mindset.*

5

Communication & Change Management

Regular updates, demos, and celebrating small wins. ***Lesson:*** *Make progress visible.*

6

Stay Curious

Learning the fundamentals helps you ask better questions. ***Lesson:*** *Curiosity builds credibility.*

Common Challenges to Avoid

Underestimating Interface Complexity

Simple-looking integrations can hide unexpected dependencies

Starting Testing Too Late

Testing with incomplete data or at the last-minute raises risk

Forgetting Third-Party Dependencies

Integrations with external systems must be planned in from the start

Involving Security / Network Teams Too Late

Connectivity and security need planning from day one

Skipping Cleanup of Obsolete Integrations

Unused interfaces should be retired before migrating

5 Traits That Make Migrations Succeed

1. **Visible Executive Sponsorship**

   Budget, priorities, and decisions don't stall waiting for approval

2. **Monitoring Designed In from Day One**

   Logging and alerting needs are agreed before the first wave

3. **A Staged Approach**

   Move forward step by step, with clear checkpoints to pause and review

4. **Reusable Patterns and Standards**

   Standard iFlow patterns and naming keep later waves fast and consistent

5. **A Single Source of Truth for Scope**

   One live inventory tracks every interface's status, owner, and wave

A Suggested Roadmap

Now

Build the inventory; classify interfaces by complexity

1–3 Months

Pick the pilot wave; select the right tool and partner

3–12 Months

Begin migrating in waves; set up regular testing and monitoring

12+ Months

Stabilize, and start benefiting from automation and new capabilities

Note: timeframes are typical ranges observed in real projects; actual duration depends on scope and complexity.

Key Takeaways

- 2027 is closer than it looks: start planning today.
- This isn't a lift-and-shift — it's a chance to simplify your processes.
- The right partner and the right method greatly reduce risk.
- The biggest risk isn't technical, it's organizational — keep business units in the room.

Thank You!

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